

US 401(k) Retirement Plan Guide

Plan: Meridian Instruments Inc. 401(k) Plan Recordkeeper: Lone Star Retirement Services Applies to: US employees of Meridian Instruments Inc. Effective: January 1, 2025 Contact: benefits@meridian-instruments.example

1. About the plan

The Meridian 401(k) plan helps you save for retirement with pre-tax and Roth contributions, plus a company match. The plan is administered by Lone Star Retirement Services, which holds your account, processes contribution elections and provides investment tools.

2. Eligibility and automatic enrollment

All US employees, including part-time employees, are eligible to contribute from their date of hire. New hires are automatically enrolled at a pre-tax contribution of 4% of eligible pay 30 days after their hire date unless they make a different election or opt out before then. If you opt out within 90 days of your first automatic contribution, you can request a refund of those contributions.

3. Company match

Meridian matches 100% of the first 4% of eligible pay you contribute, plus 50% of the next 2%. The maximum company match is therefore 5% of eligible pay when you contribute 6% or more.

You contribute | Meridian match | Total

2% | 2% | 4%

4% | 4% | 8%

5% | 4.5% | 9.5%

6% or more | 5% | 11% or more

Eligible pay includes base salary, overtime and MIP bonus. The match is calculated each pay period, and a true-up contribution is made in the first quarter of the following year if you reached the IRS contribution limit early and missed match in later pay periods.

4. Automatic escalation

If you are contributing less than 8%, your contribution rate increases automatically by 1% on each April 1 until it reaches 8%. You can opt out of automatic escalation, or choose a different increase, at any time on the Lone Star Retirement Services website.

5. Vesting

Your own contributions and the company match are 100% vested immediately. This means all the money in your account is yours, even if you leave Meridian shortly after joining.

6. Contribution limits

For 2025 the IRS elective deferral limit is \$23,500. Employees aged 50 or over can contribute an extra \$7,500 catch-up contribution, and employees aged 60 to 63 can contribute a higher catch-up of \$11,250. Pre-tax and Roth contributions count toward the same limit.

7. Roth contributions

You can choose to make some or all of your contributions as Roth 401(k) contributions, which are made after tax and can be withdrawn tax-free in retirement if IRS conditions are met. The

company match is always made as a pre-tax contribution.

8. Loans and withdrawals

The plan allows one loan outstanding at a time. The minimum loan is \$1,000 and the maximum is the lesser of 50% of your vested balance or \$50,000. Loans are repaid by payroll deduction over up to five years. Hardship withdrawals are permitted for IRS-approved reasons.

9. Making changes

You can change your contribution rate, Roth election and investments at any time on the Lone Star Retirement Services website or app. Changes take effect with the next payroll if they are made before the change cut-off in the Payroll Calendar FY2025/26 - United States. Keel shows your deductions on each pay stub but is not used to make elections.

10. Questions

Contact Lone Star Retirement Services for account and investment questions, or benefits@meridian-instruments.example for eligibility and match questions. Payroll deduction questions go to payroll-us@meridian-instruments.example.